“Fueling Global Trade, Connecting Continents”

DDS MARINE WEEKLY
MARITIME INTELLIGENCE

TANKERS | ENERGY | STS | COMPLIANCE

Insight. Safety. Excellence.

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Executive Market Dashboard

Market snapshot: 13 August 2026 | Freight narrative based on oilprice.com, Ship & Bunker, Hellenic Shipping News, Baltic Exchange and Wirana Shipping Corporation data

BRENT CRUDE **US$87.05/bbl** ▼ 2.17% intraday	WTI CRUDE **US$81.25/bbl** ▼ 2.43% intraday	SINGAPORE VLSFO **US$844.50/mt** ▼ US$3.00 d/d
SINGAPORE MGO **US$1,236.50/mt** ▲ US$26.00 d/d	BALTIC DIRTY TANKER INDEX **2,663 pts** ▲ 19 pts, 11 Aug	BRENT, WEEK-ON-WEEK **+12.1%** vs US$79.42 close, 5 Aug

DDS VIEW

Last issue we warned against reading a falling oil price as a falling risk premium. This week proves the point. Brent has round-tripped back above US$87/bbl — up over twelve percent from the 5 August close — as the reported Hormuz de-escalation has stalled and Iran has said the Strait will stay closed until the US meets its conditions. More significantly, the US naval blockade against Iranian ports that began in mid-July has turned kinetic: a US Navy helicopter fired on a Panama-flagged container ship bound for Iran on 11 August, and Hormuz transits have fallen to just 16 ships a day. Gard P&I has pulled war-risk cover across the Indian Ocean, Gulf of Aden and Red Sea effective 16 August. For Southeast Asian operators, this is the scenario Issue 002 flagged as the downside risk — it has now arrived. Insurance, routing and counterparty screening need to be re-verified this week, not assumed current.

This Week at a Glance

- **Oil:** Brent US$87.05/bbl and WTI US$81.25/bbl on 13 August, up sharply from the US$79.42/US$75.14 close on 5 August as Hormuz peace hopes fade and the EIA raises its Brent outlook to US$87/b on Hormuz shipping constraints.
- **Hormuz blockade:** A US Navy MH-60 helicopter fired Hellfire missiles at the Iran-bound container ship Vela Nova on 11 August; US forces have redirected 55 vessels, disabled three and boarded two since the blockade began in mid-July. Hormuz transits fell to 16 ships on 11 August.
- **Insurance:** Gard P&I issued a Notice of Cancellation for war risks across the Indian Ocean, Gulf of Aden and Red Sea, expanding the existing Red Sea exclusion effective 00:01 GMT 16 August, with automatic reinstatement under revised terms.
- **Bunkers:** Singapore VLSFO US$844.50/mt (−US$3.00) and MGO US$1,236.50/mt (+US$26.00), diverging as distillate tightness continues even as VLSFO holds steady.
- **Freight:** Baltic Dirty Tanker Index 2,663 (+19); Baltic Clean Tanker Index 1,351 (−36); Baltic LPG Index surged to 19,375 (+1,686) on strong US Gulf/Japan demand.

CEO Market Commentary

Capt. Dinesh Naidu KC — Founder & Chairman, DDS Marine Group

"Two weeks ago the market was pricing a Hormuz deal. This week the US Navy fired on a ship trying to reach Iran. That is the distance between headline and reality in this trade."

Issue 002 made one argument: don't read a falling oil price as a falling risk premium, because the physical market — transits, insurance, documented routing — moves more slowly and more honestly than headlines do. This week is the clearest possible confirmation of that argument. Brent has round-tripped back above US$87/bbl, up over twelve percent in a week, as reported Hormuz de-escalation has stalled and Iran has said the Strait stays closed until its conditions are met. But the more consequential development isn't the price — it's that the standoff has turned kinetic.

A US Navy helicopter fired on a Panama-flagged container ship attempting to reach an Iranian port on 11 August. That vessel was one of 55 that US forces say they have redirected since a naval blockade against Iranian ports began in mid-July, alongside three ships disabled and two boarded. Hormuz transits have fallen to 16 ships a day. This is no longer a story about insurance premiums pricing in tail risk — it is an active, ongoing military enforcement operation in the world's most important oil chokepoint, and vessels transiting the region now face a materially different risk picture than they did even two weeks ago.

The insurance market has moved accordingly. Gard P&I this week issued a Notice of Cancellation for war-risk cover across the Indian Ocean, Gulf of Aden and Red Sea — not a new exclusion, but a substantial expansion of the existing Red Sea exclusion, taking effect 00:01 GMT on 16 August. Any owner or charterer with cover through Gard, or benchmarking against Gard's terms, needs to check whether their current voyage or laycan falls inside the newly excluded boundaries before that date, not after.

For Malaysia and the wider Southeast Asian region, none of this changes the underlying case we've made since Issue 001: this is a risk-allocation market before it is a freight market, and Southeast Asia's advantage is structural — proximity to the disruption without direct exposure to it — provided our own screening and documentation standards keep pace. What changes this week is the urgency. If your P&I cover runs through Gard or a similar reinsurance-linked structure, verify your war-risk terms this week. Don't wait for the renewal cycle.

Capt. Dinesh Naidu KC
Founder & Chairman, DDS Marine Group

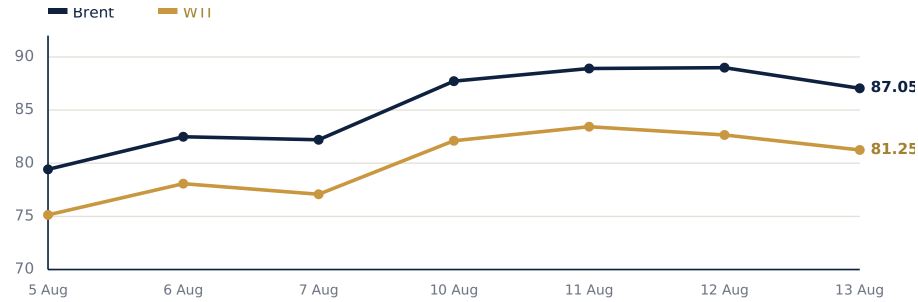
Publication Principle — Independent operational commentary based on publicly available market information from oilprice.com, Ship & Bunker, Hellenic Shipping News and Baltic Exchange, plus attributed broker/market colour from Wirana Shipping Corporation's Demo Market Report.

Global Oil Market

Prices and the week's directional move, per oilprice.com and Ship & Bunker historical series

Indicator	Latest	Reading
Brent crude	US$87.05/ bbl	Down 2.17% intraday, 13 Aug (day pullback), but up ~12.1% from the US$79.42 close on 5 Aug.
WTI crude	US$81.25/ bbl	Down 2.43% intraday, 13 Aug; up ~8.2% from the US$75.14 close on 5 Aug.
Murban crude	US$89.87/ bbl	Down 0.23% intraday — Gulf grade now trading at a premium to Brent, consistent with acute Hormuz-linked supply risk.
US crude inventories	+17.4m bbl	EIA reported a massive build for the week ending 7 Aug — yet prices rose anyway, underlining that this rally is risk-premium, not fundamentals, driven.

Brent vs. WTI — Daily Close, 5–13 August 2026 (US$/bbl)



Source: Ship & Bunker daily close series, 5–12 Aug; oilprice.com live indication, 13 Aug (intraday).

Market Interpretation

The direction has fully reversed since Issue 002. Brent closed at US$79.42/bbl on 5 August and has climbed to US$87.05/bbl intraday on 13 August — a gain of roughly twelve percent — even as EIA data shows a 17.4-million-barrel build in US crude inventories for the week ending 7 August, an increase that would ordinarily pressure prices lower. That divergence is the story: the market is pricing geopolitical risk, not supply and demand. The EIA itself has raised its Brent outlook to US$87/b explicitly citing Hormuz shipping constraints.

The proximate cause is a hardening, not a softening, of the Hormuz standoff. Reporting this week describes Iran stating the Strait will stay closed until the US meets its conditions, and oilprice.com's own coverage frames the risk as building toward US$120 oil if the stalemate persists. Most significantly, the confrontation has moved from rhetoric to kinetic action — see Geopolitical & Route Risk overleaf.

DDS BASE CASE

We now treat the risk premium as structurally embedded rather than headline-driven. With an active US naval blockade, confirmed weapons fire, and insurers pulling war-risk cover, this is no longer a market waiting to see if de-escalation holds — it is pricing an ongoing enforcement operation with no clear end date. We would expect continued volatility but see the downside case (a durable return to pre-July pricing) as considerably less likely than it appeared even two weeks ago.

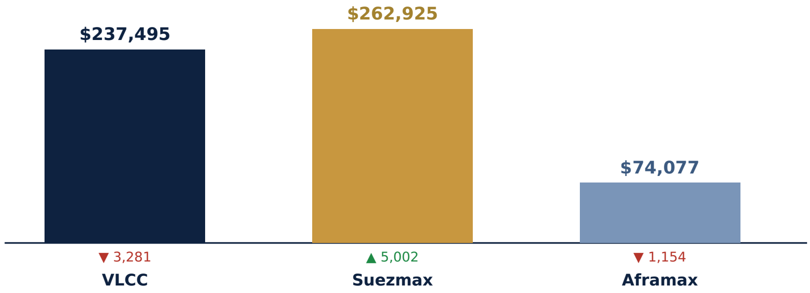
Commercial effect on shipping: Rising crude and bunker costs compound directly with this issue's war-risk and insurance developments. Owners and charterers with Gulf, Red Sea or Indian Ocean exposure should actively re-verify — not assume — that war-risk premiums, K&R cover and P&I terms reflect the current situation, given Gard's notice taking effect 16 August.

Crude Tanker Market

VLCC, Suezmax and Aframax directional assessment

Segment	Current Tone	Primary Driver
VLCC	Mixed, Hormuz-constrained	Active US naval blockade; transits down to 16 ships/day
Suezmax	Firm, Black Sea premium	TD6 Black Sea/Med up on renewed Ukrainian port attacks
Aframax	Mixed, regionally exposed	Softer North Sea/Med; firmer US Gulf/Caribs legs

Crude Tanker TCE Comparison — US$/day, Baltic Exchange, 11 August 2026



TCE: VLCC (TD3C, TD15, TD22); Suezmax (TD6, TD20); Aframax (TD7, TD8, TD14, TD19, TD25, TD26). Change shown vs. prior print.

VLCC

The Baltic Dirty Tanker Index rose 19 points to 2,663 on 11 August, but the VLCC segment itself was mixed: TD3C (Middle East Gulf/China) eased to Ws481.67 (−6.11), equivalent to US$487,420/day (−US$7,582), while VLCC TCE across TD3C, TD15 and TD22 slipped to US$237,495/day (−US$3,281). That softness sits against a hardening physical backdrop — Hormuz transits fell to 16 ships on 11 August as the US naval blockade against Iranian ports intensified, with a US Navy helicopter firing on an Iran-bound container ship the same day. The VLCC market is absorbing conflicting signals: elevated headline risk pushing charterers toward documented, compliant tonnage, against softer near-term rate momentum on the benchmark Gulf/China route.

Suezmax

Suezmax was the firmest crude segment this week. TD6 (Black Sea/Med) rose to Ws577.78 (+5.28), or US$440,948/day (+US$3,421), and TD27 (Guyana/ARA) jumped to Ws188.69 (+7.58). Suezmax TCE across TD6 and TD20 rose to US$262,925/day (+US$5,002). The strength lines up with this week's attack on major Russian grain export terminals in a Ukrainian Black Sea port strike, continuing the disruption pattern flagged in Issue 002's coverage of Ukraine's maritime campaign — Black Sea loading risk remains a persistent premium in this segment's pricing.

Aframax

Aframax was the softest crude segment, with TCE (TD7, TD8, TD14, TD19, TD25, TD26) down to US$74,077/day (−US$1,154). TD7 (North Sea/UK-Cont) fell to Ws203.33 (−4.59), and TD19 (Cross Med) eased to Ws208.06 (−5.00). Against that, US Gulf/Caribs legs firmed — TD9 (Caribs/USG) to Ws340.83 (+10.83) — while Houthis renewed attacks on Saudi energy assets, keeping Red Sea risk elevated even as European short-haul rates softened.

> **DDS VIEW**
>
> *The crude tanker complex is showing the split we'd expect from an escalating chokepoint crisis layered on a still-adjusting Black Sea market: Gulf-exposed VLCC softening slightly even as headline risk rises, Black Sea-linked Suezmax firming on renewed terminal attacks, Aframax bifurcating between a weaker Europe and firmer Americas. TD rates move on realised fixture activity, which lags the compliance and insurance response by days — we'd expect the next print to show more of the blockade's effect.*

Clean & Product Tankers

LR2, MR and refining-margin implications

The Baltic Clean Tanker Index fell 36 points to 1,351 on 11 August, a broad-based softening across almost every route. LR2 led the complex lower: TC1 (Middle East Gulf/Japan) eased to Ws520.00 (−2.50), US$139,434/day (−US$1,297), while TC20 (ME Gulf/UK-Cont) fell to US$108,137/day (−US$2,920) on a sharply lower lumpsum. LR1's TC5 (ME Gulf/Japan) softened to Ws538.75 (−1.96). The MR segment was the weakest link — the MR Atlantic Basket dropped to US$13,118/day (−US$3,966), with TC2_37 (UK-Cont/USAC) turning negative at −US$2,211/day and TC18 (US Gulf/Brazil) falling to US$17,601/day (−US$2,494). Handysize also softened, with TC6 (Algeria/Euro Med) down to Ws188.33 (−15.00).

Segment	This Week's Signal	Watch
LR2	Softer on ME Gulf/Japan and ME Gulf/UK-Cont, but still the highest-earning clean segment by a wide margin.	Whether Hormuz transit disruption starts constraining LR2 availability even as spot rates ease.
MR	Broadly weak across UK-Cont/USAC, USG/Brazil and US Gulf routes; MR Atlantic Basket down nearly 30% week-on-week.	Port congestion and arbitrage economics as bunker costs diverge (VLSFO down, MGO sharply up).
Handysize	Softer across Algeria/Euro Med and ARA/UK-Cont routes.	Regional supply/demand balance less exposed to Gulf headline risk.

DDS VIEW

The Baltic Clean Tanker Index falling 36 points in the same week that dirty tanker rates and crude prices both rose is a genuine divergence worth flagging, not just noise. It suggests product tanker owners are seeing softer near-term demand even as the crude complex reprices geopolitical risk higher — possibly reflecting refiners drawing down existing product stocks rather than committing to fresh long-haul replacement cargoes while the Hormuz situation remains this fluid. We would not read this as the all-clear on refining-margin tightness; it may simply be the market pausing to see how the blockade situation develops before committing tonnage.

Bunker Market — Singapore & Global Benchmark

Current indications in US$/mt, Ship & Bunker (shipandbunker.com), 13 August 2026

Grade	Singapore Price	Day Change	Recent High	Recent Low
VLSFO	**US$844.50/mt**	▼ −US$3.00	US$875.00	US$807.00
MGO	**US$1,236.50/mt**	▲ +US$26.00	US$1,313.50	US$1,200.00
IFO380	**US$635.50/mt**	▼ −US$3.50	US$650.00	US$625.00

Singapore vs. Other Bunkering Hubs — VLSFO, US$/mt, 13 August 2026

Source: Ship & Bunker (shipandbunker.com), 13 Aug 2026. Singapore highlighted in gold as DDS's home bunkering reference port.

Interpretation

Singapore's bunker complex diverged sharply this week: VLSFO eased US$3.00 to US$844.50/mt while MGO jumped US$26.00 to US$1,236.50/mt — a widening VLSFO/MGO spread that points to acute distillate tightness even as residual fuel holds steady. This is consistent with the refining-margin story in our Clean & Product Tankers section: diesel and other middle distillates remain the tightest part of the barrel, and Singapore's MGO move (+US$26.00) was among the largest of any port tracked this week, alongside Hong Kong (+US$28.00 on MGO) and New York (+US$25.50).

The regional pattern is mixed rather than uniformly firm: Fujairah's VLSFO fell US$13.50 even as Hong Kong and Santos rose double digits, while Rotterdam and the US ports posted modest gains. Voyage-level bunker planning should reference the specific port pair rather than a single regional average this week, given how much dispersion there is even within Asia/Pacific.

Compliance cost note: Ship & Bunker's EU ETS compliance-cost series puts the EUA-VLSFO equivalent surcharge at roughly US$303/mt this week (EUA at €82.29, +€0.30), with EUA-MGO at US$309/mt — both should be reflected explicitly in bunker and freight clauses for EU-linked calls.

Geopolitical & Route Risk

Hormuz, Red Sea, Bab el-Mandeb and the Black Sea / Sea of Azov

Area	Current Signal	Commercial Consequence
Strait of Hormuz	Active US naval blockade against Iranian ports since mid-July; US Navy fired on an Iran-bound container ship on 11 Aug; transits fell to 16 ships/day.	Materially elevated hull-war and detention risk; expect delays, boardings and possible disabling for non-compliant routing.
Bab el-Mandeb / Red Sea	Transits down to 36 ships (from 40) on 11 Aug; Houthis renew attacks on Saudi energy assets.	Gard P&I war-risk cancellation (below) directly covers this corridor from 16 Aug.
Indian Ocean / Gulf of Aden	Gard P&I issued Notice of Cancellation for war-risk cover across this zone, expanding the existing Red Sea exclusion.	Cover lapses 00:01 GMT 16 Aug and is automatically reinstated under new, narrower terms — verify laycan timing against this date.
Black Sea	Major Russian grain export terminals hit in a fresh Ukrainian Black Sea port attack this week.	Continued Suezmax/Aframax tonne-mile support; TD6 (Black Sea/Med) firmed accordingly (see Crude Tanker Market).

The Hormuz Blockade Turns Kinetic

The number of ships transiting the Strait of Hormuz fell to 16 on 11 August after US Central Command said the US Navy had engaged a container ship, with UK Maritime Trade Operations separately noting an incident between a container ship and military forces in the Gulf of Oman, per S&P Global Commodities at Sea. A US Navy MH-60 helicopter fired two Hellfire missiles at the Panama-flagged container ship *Vela Nova*, which had sailed from Jawaharlal Nehru Port in India on 6 August and was heading toward Iran in violation of the US blockade, according to CENTCOM. The vessel's manager, a China-based company, did not respond to requests for comment.

CENTCOM said US forces have redirected 55 commercial vessels attempting to run the blockade since it began in mid-July, disabled three others, and boarded two. Total crossings through the naval blockade line rose to 60 ships on 11 August from 50 the previous day — traffic is still moving, but under active US naval enforcement rather than free transit. Tanker movements continued alongside the incident: the VLCC *Vadin* departed the Gulf after loading Al Rayyan crude at Qatar, the LR1 *Mezaira'a* left after loading refined products at Sharjah, and ADNOC's MR tanker *New Future* crossed inbound toward Khor Al Zubair, Iraq.

Insurance Market Response — Gard P&I War-Risk Cancellation

Gard's P&I entities received Notice of Cancellation from their reinsurers on 12 August covering war risks in the Indian Ocean, Gulf of Aden and Red Sea, and have in turn issued cancellation notices on the affected covers — including P&I for charterers and traders, comprehensive general liability, charterers' bunkers cover, crew cover and several other lines. Gard is explicit that this is not a new exclusion but an expansion of the existing Red Sea exclusion from Member Circular 19/2023. Cover is cancelled effective 00:01 GMT on 16 August and is automatically reinstated at the same moment under a revised clause excluding the Indian Ocean, Gulf of Aden and Red Sea as newly and more broadly defined — notably, the exception for coastal waters within 12 nautical miles no longer applies to the Bab el-Mandeb Traffic Separation Scheme or the Saudi and Yemeni Red Sea coasts. Gard's mutual P&I Excess War Risks cover is unaffected. Owners and charterers with Gard-linked cover, or benchmarking war-risk terms against Gard, should check any voyage transiting these waters against the 16 August effective date now.

DDS RISK LEVEL: SEVERE — This is no longer a diplomatic standoff pricing risk into freight; it is an active naval enforcement operation with confirmed weapons fire, alongside a market-wide war-risk insurance response taking effect 16 August. No Hormuz, Red Sea, Gulf of Aden or Indian Ocean fixture should proceed without verified, current-week insurance and routing confirmation — not documentation from before 11 August.

Sanctions & Compliance Watch

Actionable controls for fixtures and STS operations

Regulatory & Insurance Developments — Week Ending 13 August 2026

- **Gard P&I, 12 August 2026:** Notice of Cancellation issued for war-risk cover across the Indian Ocean, Gulf of Aden and Red Sea, expanding the existing Red Sea exclusion under Member Circular 19/2023. Affects P&I for charterers and traders, comprehensive general liability, charterers' bunkers cover, crew cover and multiple other lines. Effective 00:01 GMT 16 August, with automatic reinstatement under the revised, narrower coastal-waters exception (full detail: Geopolitical & Route Risk, opposite).
- **US Navy / CENTCOM, 11 August 2026:** Confirmed use of force against a vessel attempting to breach the Iran-ports blockade in effect since mid-July — the clearest signal yet that this is an actively enforced military operation, not a diplomatic posture. Expect other P&I clubs and war-risk insurers to review Hormuz and Gulf of Oman terms in the coming days in response.
- **United States (OFAC), ongoing:** Issue 002 covered OFAC's 29 July designation of Persian Gulf Marine Insurance Company, HormuzSafe Marine Services Authority, and tankers YEHOPE and WELL SAIL as part of the Shamkhani network. No material update to that action this week, but the underlying concern — coerced "insurance"/toll payments to sanctioned Hormuz intermediaries — remains directly relevant given this week's legitimate insurance market disruption.

Editorial & Verification Note: For legal and accuracy reasons, DDS Marine Group publishes officially designated vessel names, IMO numbers and ownership details, and insurer notice terms, only after verifying them directly against primary sources — the OFAC SDN list, Treasury press releases, and insurers' own circulars — rather than relying on secondary summaries.

Control	Minimum Action
War-risk cover verification	Confirm current P&I war-risk terms against the Gard 16 August effective date if transiting the Indian Ocean, Gulf of Aden or Red Sea — do not rely on cover confirmed before 12 August.
Vessel screening	Screen IMO, current and former names, flag history, ownership, management, operator and ISM company.
Counterparty KYC	Verify beneficial ownership, directors, trading history, address, banking and sanctions nexus.
AIS history	Review dark periods, spoofing indicators, abnormal loitering, repeated STS patterns and identity changes.
Hormuz blockade compliance	Confirm any Iran-bound or Iran-linked voyage plan against the current US naval blockade line before departure — CENTCOM has confirmed disabling and boarding non-compliant vessels.
Pre-operation refresh	Repeat screening immediately before nomination, fixture, arrival and commencement of STS/cargo operations.
Record preservation	Keep screenshots, reports, approvals, emails, SOF and operational instructions in the job file.

Important: A vessel being absent from one sanctions list does not automatically make the transaction acceptable, and confirmed insurance from before this week's Gard notice may no longer reflect current terms. Exposure can arise through ownership, control, cargo origin, counterparties, insurers, banks, deceptive shipping practices or local-law restrictions. Complex cases require qualified sanctions counsel and bank/insurer confirmation.

Southeast Asia & STS Operations

Malaysia · Singapore · Indonesia · Thailand · Vietnam — the Malacca-to-Pengerang corridor

This week's global data reinforces, rather than changes, the structural case set out in Issue 001: as Middle East and Black Sea routing both become less predictable, Southeast Asia's position astride the Strait of Malacca and the Singapore Strait gives it an early, practical read on how owners and charterers are actually adjusting — often before the shift shows up in headline freight assessments. This week's evidence includes Thailand's 62% increase in Hormuz-linked imports as refiners diversified sourcing (per ITC data), the widening use of Cape of Good Hope routing for cargo that would once have transited the Red Sea or Black Sea directly, and Singapore's continued position as a comparatively firm Asia/Pacific bunkering hub even as prices in the Americas have pulled back.

Market	Why It Matters to Tanker & STS Operators
Malaysia	Home to Port Klang, Malacca, Muar, Linggi and the Johor STS/bunkering corridor; the physical base of DDS Marine Group's operations.
Singapore	The region's principal bunkering, storage and blending hub; MGO up US$26/mt this week on distillate tightness even as VLSFO held broadly steady.
Indonesia	Batam and Karimun sit directly opposite the Singapore Strait and remain active in STS, bunkering and offshore support.
Thailand	Recorded a 62% rise in imports of Hormuz-linked strategic products in April, per ITC data — direct evidence of trade diversion benefiting the region.
Vietnam	Growing product-import demand and a bellwether for intra-Asia clean tanker and MR trading patterns.

STS & Marine-Services Operating Standard

Operational Pillar	DDS Standard
Planning	Job-specific JPO, risk assessment, mooring plan, weather limits, communications plan and emergency response.
Vessel suitability	Compatibility review covering freeboard, manifold, fenders, hoses, mooring arrangement, vetting and cargo system.
Personnel	Qualified POAC/mooring master, pilots, surveyors, launch crew, tug support and clear command/reporting lines.
Control room	Real-time coordination with port/VTMS, owners, charterers, cargo interests, agents, tugs and service providers.
Documentation	Accurate NOR, SOF, checklists, pumping records, delay evidence, photographs and final operation report.

DDS VIEW

Southeast Asia is benefiting from Middle East and Black Sea disruption without being directly exposed to either conflict zone — a genuine structural advantage, provided the region's own screening, documentation and STS execution standards stay ahead of the volume it is absorbing. Readers who want an early, practical read on Malacca/Singapore Strait transit patterns, STS scheduling and Johor-corridor throughput should expect to find it here first.

Freight & Rate Signals

Baltic Exchange dirty, clean, LPG and LNG indices, 11 August 2026 (Tuesday) — as reported by Baltic Exchange

Restoring attributed fixture data as promised in Issue 002: selected Baltic Exchange routes, published 11 August 2026.

Baltic Dirty Tanker Index — 2,663 (+19)

Route	Rate	US$/day
TD3C — ME Gulf / China (VLCC, 270k)	Ws481.67 (−6.11)	487,420 (−7,582)
TD2 — ME Gulf / Singapore (VLCC, 270k)	Ws507.44 (+8.00)	528,362 (+7,717)
VLCC TCE (TD3C, TD15 & TD22)	—	237,495 (−3,281)
TD6 — Black Sea / Med (Suezmax, 135k)	Ws577.78 (+5.28)	440,948 (+3,421)
TD20 — WAF / UK-Cont (Suezmax, 130k)	Ws195.28 (+12.22)	84,901 (+6,582)
Suezmax TCE (TD6 & TD20)	—	262,925 (+5,002)
TD7 — North Sea / UK-Cont (Aframax, 80k)	Ws203.33 (−4.59)	96,583 (−6,218)
TD9 — Caribs / USG (Aframax, 70k)	Ws340.83 (+10.83)	93,256 (+3,150)
Aframax TCE (TD7, TD8, TD14, TD19, TD25, TD26)	—	74,077 (−1,154)

Baltic Clean Tanker Index — 1,351 (−36)

Route	Rate	US$/day
TC1 — ME Gulf / Japan (LR2, 75k)	Ws520.00 (−2.50)	139,434 (−1,297)
TC5 — ME Gulf / Japan (LR1, 55k)	Ws538.75 (−1.96)	101,568 (−901)
TC17 — ME Gulf / E Africa (MR, 35k)	Ws492.14 (−7.15)	54,819 (−1,383)
TC2_37 — UK-Cont / USAC (MR, 37k)	Ws111.25 (−6.56)	−2,211 (−1,795)
MR Atlantic Basket	—	13,118 (−3,966)
TC6 — Algeria / Euro Med (Handysize, 30k)	Ws188.33 (−15.00)	15,118 (−4,791)

Baltic LPG & LNG

Route	Rate	US$/day
Baltic LPG Index	19,375 (+1,686)	—
BLPG3 — US Gulf / Japan (44k)	$287.167/mt (+29.667)	171,116 (+22,908)
BLPG1 — ME Gulf / Japan (44k)	$220.500/mt (+14.250)	211,012 (+15,496)
BLNG1_74g — Gladstone / Tokyo RV (174k cbm)	—	71,500 (−400)
BLNG3_74g — Sabine / Tokyo RV (174k cbm)	—	62,000 (−567)

DDS VIEW

The LPG index's jump of 1,686 points is the standout number this week — BLPG3 (US Gulf/Japan) alone gained nearly US$23,000/day. Set against a softening clean index and a dry bulk market Hellenic Shipping News reports has fallen for a third straight day, the freight complex is fragmenting by segment: Black Sea-linked crude firm, Gulf-exposed clean soft, gas carriers picking up dislocation elsewhere.

Source note: Baltic Exchange data as published 11 Aug 2026. Not all reported routes shown; selected for relevance to DDS's SE Asia/Middle East corridor readership.

◆ Ship Recycling & Demolition Market

Indian Subcontinent & Turkey — new to DDS Weekly Maritime Intelligence this issue, sourced from Wirana Shipping Corporation's Demo Market Report, 10 August 2026 (Report No.184)

Recycling and demolition sit at the other end of the tanker lifecycle from the fixture data elsewhere — the same sanctioned and ageing tonnage in our Compliance Watch often ends its life on the beaches of the Indian subcontinent. New, recurring section.

Market	This Week's Signal
India	Steel market improved for a second consecutive week; recycler prices held steady. Local steel plate +US$4/MT, imported scrap +US$1/MT. A US$41bn foreign-currency inflow programme (running to end-September) is keeping the rupiah stable despite rising oil. Outlook: recycler prices expected to improve.
Pakistan	Steel and recycler prices flat. Imported shredded scrap −US$5/MT. DGPS and the Ministry of Maritime Affairs gained new enforcement powers under the Environmentally Sound Management of Inventory of Hazardous Materials on Ships Bill 2026 (effective 21 May 2026). Central bank held rates at 11.50%. Outlook: unchanged.
Bangladesh	Steel market slow; recycler prices softened by roughly US$10–15/LT LDT. Local steel plate +US$4/MT, local scrap +US$2/MT, but imported scrap grades fell US$4–5/MT. Letter-of-Credit difficulties reported for importers. Outlook: prices under pressure.
Turkey	Steel market stable; recycler prices unchanged. Lloyd's Register newly authorised as Recognized Organization for Document of Authorization for Ship Recycling (DASR) issuance under HKC. Outlook: unchanged.
China	No foreign-flagged recycling accepted since 1 January 2019; breakers recycle domestic Chinese tonnage only.

Supply & Market Outlook

Circulation of new recycling candidates remained slow, drawn mainly from the dry bulk segment; sanctioned tanker tonnage continues moving to India on a regular basis, though in limited numbers at any one time. Wirana's broader outlook describes a weaker tanker charter market across all sizes, a mixed dry bulk picture with Capesize/Panamax outperforming, continued container strength, softer LNG rates, and a steady-to-improving LPG market — consistent with this issue's Baltic index data.

Demolition Sales, 3–7 August 2026

Type	Vessel	Built	DWT	LDT	Price	Remarks
Container	Wantong 498	1997	4,505	1,589	—	Chittagong
Cement Carrier	Asia Cement No. 3	1989	12,332	3,626	—	As-is Taiwan, for Gadani
Drillship	Sagar Vijay	1985	9,239	8,614	US$673/LDT	As-is Mumbai, incl. 1,000 MT steel & 4 generators

Vessels & LDT Beached — August, Year-on-Year

Year	India (vessels / LDT)	Bangladesh (vessels / LDT)	Pakistan (vessels / LDT)
Aug 2026	1 / 43,402	3 / 9,808	0 / 0
Aug 2025	11 / 111,276	3 / 36,663	3 / 13,747
Aug 2024	10 / 80,065	11 / 56,200	2 / 15,435

DDS VIEW

The year-on-year drop in Indian beaching volumes (11 vessels/111,276 LDT in Aug 2025 to just 1 vessel/43,402 LDT this August), against firmer Bangladesh and Pakistan pricing, is worth watching as a leading indicator of tonnage flow. With Wirana noting sanctioned tankers moving to India "on a regular basis," recycling flows cross-check this issue's sanctions themes.

Source note: Data drawn from Wirana Shipping Corporation's Demo Market Report & Market Outlook, 10 Aug 2026 (Report No. 184/03080826/10082026), reproduced with attribution as broker/market colour. Wirana's disclaimer applies.

Seven-Day Outlook: 14–20 August 2026

Market	Base Case	Upside Risk	Downside Risk
Crude oil	Continued strength/volatility in a US$80–95/bbl range while the Hormuz blockade remains active.	A confirmed de-escalation and stand-down of the naval blockade, unlocking transit volumes.	A further military incident, or an attack on Gulf export infrastructure, pushing toward the US$120/bbl case flagged by oilprice.com.
VLCC	Mixed rates despite elevated risk; watch for the blockade's effect to show up in the next Baltic print.	Blockade stand-down releasing pent-up Gulf loading demand.	Further vessel engagements deterring owners from Gulf-transiting fixtures altogether.
Suezmax / Black Sea	Firm on continued Ukrainian attacks on Russian Black Sea export infrastructure.	Further terminal strikes extending Suezmax tonne-mile demand.	A ceasefire or lull in Black Sea attacks easing the route premium.
Insurance / P&I	Gard's 16 Aug war-risk cancellation takes effect; other clubs likely to review Hormuz/ Gulf of Oman terms.	Coordinated industry response improving clarity on standard terms.	Further clubs following Gard, tightening cover and raising premiums across the board.
Clean/ products	Soft near-term on this week's Baltic clean index fall, though refining-margin fundamentals remain tight.	Further refinery disruption re-tightening the physical market quickly.	Continued destocking keeping clean tanker demand soft into next issue.
Bunkers	MGO/distillate tightness persists; VLSFO broadly range-bound.	A reversal of the crude rally easing bunker costs.	Distillate tightness spreading further, pushing MGO higher still.

Watch List

- Whether the US naval blockade against Iranian ports escalates further, de-escalates, or remains at its current intensity.
- Whether other P&I clubs follow Gard's lead on Indian Ocean/Gulf of Aden/Red Sea war-risk terms ahead of the 16 August effective date.
- Further Ukrainian strikes on Russian Black Sea export/grain terminals and any Russian retaliation affecting shipping.
- Whether next week's Baltic indices show the Hormuz transit collapse feeding through into VLCC and Aframax rates.
- Confirmation of whether the LPG index's sharp jump this week (+1,686 pts) is a one-off or the start of a trend.
- Indian subcontinent recycling volumes into September, against this week's sharply lower year-on-year Indian beaching numbers.

DDS CONCLUSION

This week validated the caution urged in Issue 002: the gap between financial-market optimism and physical-market risk closed the hard way, with a confirmed US Navy engagement and a market-wide war-risk insurance response. The operator's task now is straightforward but urgent — verify, don't assume, that insurance, routing and screening reflect this week's developments, not last week's headlines.

Methodology, Sources & Disclaimer

ISSUE 003

DDS Weekly Maritime Intelligence combines public market data, official regulatory releases, reputable news reporting and operator-focused analysis. Freight commentary is directional and does not reproduce proprietary broker assessments or subscription-only indices.

Source	Information Used
oilprice.com, 13 Aug 2026	Brent US$87.05/bbl, WTI US$81.25/bbl, Murban US$89.87/bbl (live indications); editorial coverage of Hormuz stalemate, EIA Brent outlook revision, and refining-margin developments.
Ship & Bunker (shipandbunker.com), 13 Aug 2026	Singapore, Fujairah, Rotterdam, Houston, Hong Kong, Santos, LA/Long Beach and New York VLSFO, MGO and IFO380 indications; WTI/Brent historical daily series, 5–12 Aug 2026; EU ETS compliance-cost series.
Hellenic Shipping News Worldwide (hellenicshippingnews.com), 13 Aug 2026	Hormuz naval blockade and Vela Nova incident (source: S&P Global Platts); Gard P&I war-risk cancellation notice (source: Gard); Black Sea grain terminal attack; Houthi Saudi energy-asset attacks; Baltic Dry Index and EIA crude-stocks reporting.
Baltic Exchange, 11 Aug 2026	Dirty, clean, LPG and LNG tanker index data (TD/TC/BLPG/BLNG routes), as reported.
Wirana Shipping Corporation, 10 Aug 2026	Demo Market Report & Market Outlook, Report No.184/03080826/10082026 — India/Pakistan/Bangladesh/Turkey/China ship recycling commentary, demolition sales, and price statistics.

What's changed since Issue 002 (6 August 2026): Brent has reversed sharply, rising ~12% as Hormuz de-escalation hopes have faded and Iran says the Strait stays closed until its conditions are met. The US naval blockade against Iranian ports has turned kinetic, with a confirmed US Navy engagement on 11 August. Gard P&I has cancelled war-risk cover across the Indian Ocean, Gulf of Aden and Red Sea effective 16 August. This issue also introduces two new recurring sections: a full Baltic Exchange freight-rate breakdown (restoring attributed fixture data as promised last issue) and a Ship Recycling & Demolition Market page covering the Indian subcontinent and Turkey.

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